PHILOSOPHY COURSES

Department of Philosophy & Religion • Mississippi State University

Spring 2027

INTRODUCTORY COURSES

PHI 1103
Intro to Philosophy
Multiple sections available. Exploration of classical philosophical questions.

PHI 1113
Intro to Logic
Multiple sections available. Formal and informal principles of valid reasoning.

PHI 1123
Intro to Ethics
Multiple sections available. Major theories of moral value and personal decision-making.

UPPER-LEVEL & SPECIALIZED SEMINARS

PHI 2223 – Philosophy of Fantasy Sports
MW 3:30–4:45 | Dr. Rodiero

This course uses the framework of fantasy sports to explore core concepts in political philosophy, including justice, legitimacy, and fairness.

PHI 3023 – Business Ethics
TT 3:30–4:45 | Dr. Burmeister

A philosophical exploration of how to recognize, analyze, and implement ethical decision within the multivalued contexts of the various fields of business.

PHI 3033 – History of Western Philosophy II
MW 3:30–4:45 | Dr. Lebanidze

A survey of major figures from the Renaissance through contemporary philosophy. History I is not required.

PHI 3113 – Philosophy of Law
MW 12:30–1:45 | Dr. Rodiero

This course introduces major thinkers and debates in jurisprudence, examining the nature and justification of law, legal interpretation, the relationship between law and morality, punishment, and the duty to obey the law.

PHI 3153 – Aesthetics
MW 2:00–3:15 | Dr. Dyck

We'll try to get a grip on beauty, ugliness, the sublime, art, entertainment, nature, and their proper role in daily life. We'll ask: Is beauty subjective, in the eye of the beholder? Or is it objective, "out there" to be enjoyed by everyone? Is beauty fundamentally related to truth and goodness? Or is beauty harmful, rooted in the selfish ego? And what about art? Does art aim at beauty or is it another kind of project altogether?

PHI 3123 – Philosophy of Religion
TT 11:00–12:15 | Dr. Neal

A critical inquiry into the rational justification of central theistic beliefs, with emphasis on the traditional philosophical arguments for and against the existence of God.

PHI 3173 – Social and Political Philosophy
TT 2:00–3:15 | Dr. Erck

An advanced exploration of justice and legitimacy with an emphasis on contemporary theory. Topics include: Liberalism, Republicanism, Socialism, and Libertarianism. Questions discussed: Is equality truly valuable? Who deserves to rule? What are the proper limits on the government's power to coerce individuals?

PHI 3323 – Medical Ethics
TT 2:00–3:15, TT 3:30–4:45 | Dr. Moffatt

A philosophical study of situations requiring ethical decision making in the areas of medicine.

PHI 4223 – Philosophy of Cognitive Science
TT 12:30–1:45 | Dr. Thompson

This class will serve as a general introduction to the cognitive sciences as well as an examination of some philosophical issues that emerge from studying the mind. Within linguistics, we will explore the extent to which linguistic abilities are innate and uniquely human. Within computer science, we will consider the possibility of artificial intelligence and try to understand the parallels between thought and different varieties of computation. Within psychology, we will look at evolutionary pressures on thought and whether thinking produces a true view of reality or merely a view of reality that allows us to get by. Within neuroscience, we will explore the lingering puzzles surrounding how the brain could possibly give rise to the full range of conscious experience and emotion.